

YELLOWSTONE

& THE GRAND TETONS

JUNE 20 – 28, 2026

8 adults · 4 kids · 1 baby

BZN → Mammoth ×3 → Grant Village ×2 → Jackson Lake Lodge ×3 → JAC · No cell service in most of the parks — keep this handy

Quick Reference

→ FLIGHTS

SAT JUN 20

Fly in → Bozeman (BZN) Landing morning / early afternoon. Grab cars, brewery lunch, grocery run, then south through Paradise Valley.

SUN JUN 28

Fly out ← Jackson Hole (JAC) Early-afternoon departures. Leave the lodge by ~10:30am — JAC is small but summer security lines are real.

🏠 HOTELS

JUN 20 – 23 · 3 NIGHTS

Mammoth Hot Springs Hotel

JUN 23 – 25 · 2 NIGHTS

Grant Village

JUN 25 – 28 · 3 NIGHTS

Jackson Lake Lodge

🍽️ BOOKED DINNERS — DON'T BE LATE

TUE JUN 23 · 7:30 PM

Grant Village Restaurant — Lakeside dining room. Casual.

WED JUN 24 · 4:45 PM

Lake Yellowstone Hotel Dining Room — The fancy one — 1891 colonial hotel, string quartet in the sunroom. Collared-shirt-ish.

SAT JUN 27 · 5:15 PM

The Mural Room, Jackson Lake Lodge — 3 tables of 4 · sunset on the Tetons through 60-ft windows.

Weather Outlook & Game-Time Calls

Forecast snapshot pulled June 21, 2026 — re-check at any lodge with wifi.

DATE	BASE	PLAN	FORECAST	CALL
Mon 22	Mammoth	Canyon + Mt. Washburn	Overcast 74° · 16% rain · calm	Go
Tue 23	→ Grant	Drive + geyser basins	Clear 0–1% rain — driest day	Best day for it
Wed 24	Grant	Old Faithful, Grand Prismatic	Drizzle 74° · 15%	Fine — geysers love damp
Thu 25	→ JLL	Storm Point, Colter Bay	Overcast 77° · 7%	Go
Fri 26	JLL	Jenny Lake + Cascade Canyon	Warm 80° · 13% · gusts 35	BEST Teton day — do big hikes now
Sat 27	JLL	Town, breweries, Mural Room	Cold 62° · 53% · t-storms · gusts 44	Town day; skip exposed hikes & tram
Sun 28	Fly out	Drive to JAC	51° · snow showers up high · 43%	Pad the drive

Verdict: stick with the structure — the big Teton hike already sits on the best day (Fri 26). Two tweaks:

- **Pull the big alpine hikes to Friday (26th).** Amphitheater/Surprise Lakes & Delta Lake share the Lupine Meadows trailhead with Cascade Canyon — stack them on the best day.
- **Make Saturday (27th) the town day.** Cold, wet, t-storms, 44 mph gusts. Jackson + breweries + shops fit it perfectly, and the Mural Room dinner (5:15, indoors) is ideally placed. Move the sunrise photo run to **Friday morning**.
- **Skip the aerial tram Saturday** — high wind = wind-hold + whiteout views. Friday is the only tram window.

Day by Day

01 SAT · JUN 20 Wheels Down & Westward

🏠 Mammoth Hot Springs Hotel · 🚗 BZN → Mammoth · ~85 mi · 1h 50m through Paradise Valley

Land in Bozeman, eat, stock up, then one of the prettiest drives in Montana down US-89 to the park's original front door.

BEER 🍺 **Brewery lunch in Bozeman.** MAP Brewing (pond + mountain patio), Bridger Brewing (pizza, near MSU), Mountains Walking (hazies + great kitchen), or Bozeman Brewing taproom. Pick one, fuel up.

MUST-SEE 🏰 **Roosevelt Arch, Gardiner.** Group photo under the 1903 arch — “For the Benefit and Enjoyment of the People.” Then 5 min up the hill to Mammoth.

RENDEZVOUS: Check-in at Mammoth, dinner together at the hotel dining room or Gardiner.

FUEL & SUPPLIES: Mammoth: hotel Dining Room (reserve-ish), Terrace Grill (counter service), Mammoth General Store. Gardiner (5 min): Yellowstone Pizza Co., Wonderland Cafe, Gardiner Market (groceries), gas.

LOCKED IN 🛒 **The Big Grocery Run.** Costco / Albertsons / Town & Country in Bozeman. Coolers, snacks, baby supplies, road beers (for camp), breakfast stuff. Park stores are pricey and thin — this stop is load-bearing.

EASY/BABY 🐮 **Evening: elk on the lawn.** Elk graze the Mammoth parade ground most evenings. Easy stroll around Upper Terrace Drive before dinner. Stay 25 yds back — they're spicy in June.

02 SUN · JUN 21 Lamar Valley Magic ✨ Dan's holy ground — do not skip

🏠 Mammoth Hot Springs Hotel · 🚗 Mammoth → Lamar · ~28 mi · 50 min each way

The Serengeti of North America. Dawn is when the valley performs: wolves, bison herds with red dogs (June calves!), pronghorn, maybe a grizzly. This is the day the alarm clocks earn their keep.

MUST-SEE 🌅 **Dawn patrol (leave ~5:30am).** Coffee in thermoses, kids in blankets, drive to Lamar in the half-light. Park at Slough Creek with the wolf-watchers — they'll usually share scopes. Bison jams guaranteed.

EASY/BABY 🐾 **Pullout safari (baby-approved).** The entire Lamar road is pullout after pullout. Wildlife watching from camp chairs while the baby naps in the car seat. Binoculars mandatory.

EASY/BABY 🍦 **Tower Fall + ice cream.** 132-ft waterfall, 5-minute overlook walk, general store ice cream. Hits on the drive back. Undine Falls + Wraith Falls (1 mi) are bonus stops near Mammoth, and the Petrified Tree is a 2-minute detour.

RENDEZVOUS: Late lunch back at Mammoth or picnic at Slough Creek. Compare wildlife tallies — winner picks dinner.

FUEL & SUPPLIES: Pack a cooler picnic — there is NOTHING to buy in Lamar (that's the point). Tower Fall General Store for ice cream + snacks. Dinner back at Mammoth/Gardiner.

BIG HIKE 🐟 **Trout Lake.** 1.2 mi RT, one steep-ish climb, then a perfect lake with otters and cutthroat trout. The best effort-to-magic ratio in the park.

MEDIUM 🐏 **Yellowstone River Picnic Trail.** 3.7 mi RT along the rim of the canyon narrows near Tower — Calcite Springs steaming below, bighorn sheep on the cliffs, a tenth of the crowds. Wilder cousin next door: Hellroaring (4 mi RT) drops to a suspension bridge over the river — the climb back out is real.

BIG HIKE 🏔️ **Sleepers-in: Bunsen Peak.** For anyone who refuses the 5:30 alarm — 4.6 mi RT / 1,300 ft right out of Mammoth, 360° summit views. Mellow: Beaver Ponds Loop (5 mi) straight from the hotel, or the Terraces boardwalk slow.

03 MON · JUN 22 The Grand Canyon of the Yellowstone

🏠 Mammoth Hot Springs Hotel · 🚗 Mammoth → Canyon via Dunraven Pass · ~38 mi · 1h 15m (gorgeous)

A 308-ft waterfall pouring into a canyon painted yellow, pink and orange. Split up by legs, regroup at the rim.

BIG HIKE 🐏 **Mt. Washburn.** 6.2 mi RT · 1,400 ft from Dunraven Pass to a 10,243-ft fire lookout. Bighorn sheep, wildflowers, hundred-mile views. The trip's first Big One. Bring layers — it's windy up top.

MEDIUM 🏞️ **South Rim to Point Sublime.** From Artist Point keep walking — 2.6 mi RT along the rim to railings hanging over the canyon's wildest stretch. Or loop Clear Lake–Ribbon Lake (5.5 mi) through bubbling backcountry thermal fields. Brink of the Upper Falls is a 5-minute bonus stop.

MUST-SEE 🌋 **Norris on the loop home.** Porcelain Basin boardwalk (0.8 mi) — hissing, steaming, otherworldly. Home of Steamboat, the world's tallest geyser. Optional if energy allows; otherwise it's tomorrow's first stop.

RENDEZVOUS: Artist Point at 3:00 PM — full-crew canyon photo.

FUEL & SUPPLIES: Canyon Village: Canyon Lodge Eatery (cafeteria, easy with kids), Canyon General Store (old-school lunch counter), gas + groceries-lite.

BIG HIKE 🙌 **Brink of the Lower Falls.** Only 0.7 mi RT but steep switchbacks — you stand at the LIP of the falls and feel it in your chest. Strong kids OK, not stroller territory.

EASY/BABY 🎨 **Artist Point + Grand View.** Paved, stroller-friendly, and genuinely the best view in the park. The painting-famous one. Hit multiple rim overlooks by car.

04 TUE · JUN 23 South to the Lake

Moving day → Grant Village

Grant Village · Mammoth → Grant · ~70 mi · 2h 15m driving + stops all day

Check out of Mammoth and make a day of the drive south — geyser basins, paint pots and waterfalls all the way down to Yellowstone Lake.

MUST-SEE **Norris Geyser Basin.** If skipped yesterday: the hottest, weirdest basin in the park. Porcelain Basin loop is 0.8 mi of boardwalk through a steaming moonscape.

EASY/BABY **Artists Paintpots.** 1 mi loop, bubbling pastel mud pots that sound like a soup pot. Top-tier kid content. Gibbon Falls is a 30-second stop just down the road.

LOCKED IN **DINNER: Grant Village Restaurant · 7:30 PM.** Booked! Lakeside dining room, casual. Don't be the table that's late because of a bison jam — pad the drive.

RENDEZVOUS: Grant Village Restaurant, 7:30 PM sharp.

FUEL & SUPPLIES: Grant Village: the Restaurant (booked tonight), Lake House Grill (casual, on the water), Grant General Store + mini-store, gas station. This is the southern supply post — top off everything.

05 WED · JUN 24 Geyser Royalty

Grant Village · Grant → Old Faithful · 19 mi · 35 min. OF → Lake Hotel · ~45 mi · 1h.

The greatest hits day: Old Faithful, the Grand Prismatic rainbow, a log-palace lobby — then dress up(ish) for dinner at the grand old Lake Hotel.

MUST-SEE **Old Faithful + Upper Geyser Basin.** Catch an eruption (every ~90 min — check predictions, grab benches early), then walk the boardwalk past Grand, Castle + Morning Glory Pool. Gawk at the Old Faithful Inn lobby. Huckleberry ice cream downstairs.

BIG HIKE **Fairy Falls.** 5.4 mi RT, dead flat, ends at a lacy 200-ft waterfall. The mellow Big Hike — kids with stamina can do it.

MEDIUM **Elephant Back before dinner.** 3.6 mi loop · 800 ft, topping out on a panorama of Yellowstone Lake — and the trail ends a few steps from the Lake Hotel porch. Earn the 4:45 reservation.

EASY/BABY **Hayden Valley dusk drive.** After dinner, loop home through Hayden at golden hour — prime bison + grizzly time, all from the car. Baby-proof wildlife viewing.

RENDEZVOUS: Lake Yellowstone Hotel lobby, 4:30 PM, looking respectable.

FUEL & SUPPLIES: Old Faithful area: Inn Dining Room, Bear Paw Deli (grab-and-go), OF Lodge cafeteria, TWO general stores (the Lower Store has a 1950s lunch counter). Fishing Bridge General Store near Lake.

MEDIUM **Monument Geyser Basin.** 2 mi RT, short but steep — ghostly old sinter cones on a ridge with the whole Gibbon valley at your feet. Roaring Mountain's hissing slope is a free pullout on the way down from Norris.

EASY/BABY **West Thumb at golden hour.** 0.6 mi boardwalk where hot springs spill into Yellowstone Lake — 2 minutes from Grant. Stroller-OK. Perfect pre-dinner leg-stretch.

MUST-SEE **Grand Prismatic — twice.** Midway boardwalk (0.8 mi, stroller-OK) puts you at the steaming rim; the Overlook (1.2 mi RT from Fairy Falls TH) gets you THE photo. Do the overlook if you pick one. Biscuit Basin remains closed (2024 hydrothermal explosion).

MEDIUM **Observation Point + Lone Star.** Observation Point (1.6 mi RT) puts Old Faithful's eruption below you instead of in front of you. Lone Star Geyser is 4.8 flat miles RT of old service road to a 12-ft cone that fires every ~3 hours — check the trailhead logbook and time it. Quick bonus stops: Black Sand Basin, Kepler Cascades.

LOCKED IN **DINNER: Lake Yellowstone Hotel · 4:45 PM.** Booked! The 1891 grande dame — sunroom, string quartet energy, collared shirts encouraged. Leave the geysers by 3:30.

06 THU · JUN 25 Two Parks, One Day 🚗 Moving day → Jackson Lake Lodge

🏠 Jackson Lake Lodge · 🚗 Grant → JLL · ~46 mi · 1h via the South Entrance + Rockefeller Parkway

Trade geysers for granite. An easy morning on Yellowstone Lake, then south past Lewis Falls into the Tetons — and the lodge with the best lobby view in America.

BIG HIKE 🏞️ **Storm Point loop.** 2.3 mi easy loop to a blustery point over Yellowstone Lake. Marmots everywhere. Great pre-drive energy burn for the kids.

EASY/BABY 🏖️ **Colter Bay beach afternoon.** Kids + baby swim/splash in Jackson Lake with the Tetons across the water. Lakeshore trail (2 mi) is stroller-able. Leek's Marina pizza on the water for lazy lunch.

EASY/BABY 🏠 **Lodge arrival ritual.** Check in, walk into the lobby, let the 60-ft windows do their thing. Cocktail at the Blue Heron Lounge, kids on the back terrace, Lunch Tree Hill (0.5 mi) for sunset.

RENDEZVOUS: Blue Heron Lounge terrace, golden hour.

FUEL & SUPPLIES: JLL: Mural Room (booked Sat), Pioneer Grill (1950s diner counter — milkshakes, kid paradise), Blue Heron Lounge. Colter Bay (10 min): Ranch House, café court, and the best general store on the trip.

07 FRI · JUN 26 Jenny Lake Day

🏠 Jackson Lake Lodge · 🚗 JLL → Jenny Lake · ~18 mi · 30 min. Go EARLY — lots fill by 9am.

The Tetons' crown jewel. A boat ride across a glacial lake, a waterfall, a viewpoint, and — for the strong of leg — the canyon between the spires.

MUST-SEE 🚢 **Jenny Lake boat → Hidden Falls.** Shuttle boats cross all day (kids LOVE it). From the dock: 0.5 mi to Hidden Falls, then 1 mi / 400 ft up to Inspiration Point. Most of the crew can do this one.

BIG HIKE 🏔️ **Alt big: Surprise & Amphitheater Lakes.** 9.6 mi RT · ~3,000 ft of relentless switchbacks from Lupine Meadows to two alpine cirque lakes tucked under the Grand itself. Trade Cascade Canyon for this if you want the full burn.

EASY/BABY 🏖️ **String Lake base camp.** Shallow, sandy-edged, the warmest water in the park, Mount Moran straight ahead. Set up chairs and let the kids + baby live their best lives. Arrive early for parking.

RENDEZVOUS: Dornan's deck, ~5:30 PM.

FUEL & SUPPLIES: Jenny Lake Store at the visitor center (snacks). Dornan's Trading Post in Moose = real grocery + deli. Signal Mountain Lodge (Trapper Grill, nachos the size of a child) is the mid-valley option.

MEDIUM 🌲 **Shoshone Lake via DeLacy Creek.** Before leaving Yellowstone: 3 flat-ish miles of creekside meadow each way to the largest backcountry lake in the lower 48 — moose like it as much as people do. Shorter alt: Yellowstone Lake Overlook from West Thumb, 2 mi RT / 400 ft, the geyser basin and lake from above.

MEDIUM 🏔️ **Grand View Point at golden hour.** Ten minutes north of the lodge: 2.2 mi RT · 550 ft through lodgepole forest to a ledge with Two Ocean Lake below and the whole range stacked behind Jackson Lake.

MUST-SEE 🌅 **Oxbow Bend at dusk.** 5 min from the lodge — Mt. Moran reflected in the Snake River, moose + eagles on patrol. You'll be back at sunrise.

BIG HIKE 🏔️ **Cascade Canyon.** Continue past Inspiration Point into the canyon — granite walls, moose ponds, snowfields. Turn around whenever; the forks are ~9–10 mi RT total. THE Teton big hike.

MEDIUM 🌿 **Leigh Lake shoreline.** Flat 1.8 mi RT from the String Lake lot (keep going as long as legs allow) — sandy coves staring straight up Mount Moran, and far fewer people than Jenny. The mellow-medium counterweight to the boat-dock crowds.

BEER 🍷 **Evening: Dornan's in Moose.** Pizza + pasta on the deck, the Grand Teton filling the sky, surprisingly great wine shop next door. Casual, loud, perfect for 13 people.

08 SAT · JUN 27 Split-Up Saturday

Mural Room finale · 5:15 PM

🚩 Jackson Lake Lodge · 🚗 JLL → Jackson town · ~36 mi · 50 min

Choose your own adventure: dawn photos, a proper summit-ish hike, or a town day with the breweries — then everyone cleans up for the big farewell dinner under the murals.

MUST-SEE 🇺🇸 **Sunrise photo run.** Oxbow Bend → Snake River Overlook (the Ansel Adams shot) → Schwabacher Landing → Mormon Row, all before 8am light. Moulton barns + mirror-pond Tetons. The shots that end up framed.

MEDIUM 🌿 **Phelps Lake · LSR Preserve.** The Rockefeller family's old retreat, gifted to the park — hushed trails to a green-blue lake with a famous jumping rock. 3–7 mi depending on your loop. The tiny lot fills by 9am; worth the alarm.

BEER 🍺 **Jackson brewery crawl.** Snake River Brewing (WY's oldest — beer garden + wood-fired pizza, kids fine), Roadhouse Pub & Eatery just off the square, StillWest at Snow King with the patio. Pace yourselves — dinner's at 5:15.

LOCKED IN 🗨️ **DINNER: The Mural Room · 5:15 PM.** Booked — 3 tables of 4! Trapper murals, white tablecloths, and the Tetons going gold through the windows. Be back at the lodge by 4:30 to de-trail-dust.

RENDEZVOUS: Mural Room, 5:15 PM. Pack tonight — wheels up tomorrow.

FUEL & SUPPLIES: Jackson has everything: Persephone Bakery (morning), Liberty Burger, Snake River Brewing et al. Albertsons + a liquor store for any last supplies.

09 SUN · JUN 28 One Last Look

🚩 Fly out of JAC · 🚗 JLL → JAC · ~28 mi · 40 min. Leave by ~10:30 for early-afternoon flights.

Slow coffee, one more mountain stare, and the only airport in America inside a national park.

EASY/BABY ☕ **Coffee at Oxbow Bend.** Five minutes from the lodge. Thermos coffee, morning light on Moran, maybe a moose sendoff.

LOCKED IN ✈️ **JAC by ~12:00.** Tiny airport, real summer lines. Gas up in Jackson or at Dornan's. Window seats on the left flying south — one last Teton flyby.

RENDEZVOUS: Group hug at the gate. Start the 2027 group chat immediately.

FUEL & SUPPLIES: Pioneer Grill breakfast (milkshake for the road is legal), or Persephone in Jackson if you leave early.

BIG HIKE 🦋 **Taggart Lake (family) or Delta Lake (heroes).** Taggart: 3.8 mi RT, gentle, swimmable lake. Delta: 7.4 mi RT / 2,300 ft, unofficial trail, turquoise glacier lake — strenuous sendoff for the strong hikers only.

MUST-SEE 🗨️ **Big Red tram to 10,450 ft.** Jackson Hole's aerial tram out of Teton Village: 12 minutes to the top of Rendezvous Peak, waffles at Corbet's Cabin, zero effort for a full summit. Kids think it's a ride. It is. Cunningham Cabin is a quick photo pull on the drive.

EASY/BABY 🍪 **Town Square + shops.** Antler arches, boardwalks, huckleberry taffy, cowboy kitsch. Stagecoach rides for the kids. Scenic Snake River float trips launch nearby (kids ~4+, book ahead).

EASY/BABY 🌳 **Lunch Tree Hill.** 0.5 mi behind the lodge — where JD Rockefeller decided this view needed protecting. Fitting last walk.

Camp Notes — Food & Stores

Mammoth Hot Springs Hotel

JUN 20 - 23 · 3 NIGHTS · 6,200 FT

EAT

- Mammoth Dining Room — the sit-down (reservations smart)
- Terrace Grill — burgers/counter service, fast with kids
- Gardiner (5 min): Yellowstone Pizza Co., Wonderland Cafe, Iron Horse Bar & Grill

Grant Village

JUN 23 - 25 · 2 NIGHTS · 7,800 FT

EAT

- Grant Village Restaurant — booked Tue 7:30 PM
- Lake House Grill — casual, right on the water
- Old Faithful area (35 min): Bear Paw Deli, Inn Dining Room, geyser-side lunch counters

Jackson Lake Lodge

JUN 25 - 28 · 3 NIGHTS · 6,800 FT

EAT

- The Mural Room — booked Sat 5:15 PM (the finale)
- Pioneer Grill — 1950s diner counter, milkshakes, kids love it
- Blue Heron Lounge — cocktails + that view
- Nearby: Leek's Marina pizza, Signal Mountain's Trapper Grill, Dornan's in Moose

STORES & SUPPLIES

- Mammoth General Store — snacks, souvenirs, basics
- Gardiner Market — real grocery store, beer, diapers
- Gas in Mammoth + Gardiner

STORES & SUPPLIES

- Grant Village General Store + mini-store
- Gas station at Grant
- Fishing Bridge General Store (40 min, near Lake Hotel)

STORES & SUPPLIES

- Colter Bay General Store (10 min) — best store in the Tetons
- Dornan's Trading Post, Moose — grocery + deli + famous wine shop
- Gas at Colter Bay, Signal Mountain + Moran Junction

The Brewery Log

MAP Brewing Co. BOZEMAN, MT · DAY 1 LUNCH · KIDS: YES — FULL KITCHEN

Patio on a pond staring at the Bridgers. The official first-beer-of-the-trip spot.

Bridger Brewing BOZEMAN, MT · DAY 1 ALT · KIDS: YES — PIZZA PLACE

Artisan pizza + their Vigilante IPA, near MSU campus.

Mountains Walking Brewery BOZEMAN, MT · DAY 1 ALT · KIDS: YES — REAL

FOOD MENU

Hazy specialists with a legit kitchen in the northeast arts district.

Bozeman Brewing Co. BOZEMAN, MT · DAY 1 ALT · KIDS: TAPROOM — QUICK ONE

The OG of Bozeman (2001). Bozone Amber is the classic.

Snake River Brewing JACKSON, WY · DAY 8 LUNCH · KIDS: VERY — BEER GARDEN

+ PIZZA

Wyoming's oldest brewery, twice GABF Small Brewery of the Year. Zonker Stout is the legend.

Roadhouse Pub & Eatery JACKSON, WY · DAY 8 · KIDS: YES — FULL RESTAURANT

Chef-founded, 20+ taps, half a block off the Town Square. Mountain Jam hazy is the move.

StillWest Brewery & Grill JACKSON, WY · DAY 8 · KIDS: YES — UPSCALE GRILL

Base of Snow King with a patio aimed at the mountain. Brewery + proper restaurant.

Dornan's MOOSE, WY · DAY 7 DINNER · KIDS: EXTREMELY

Not a brewery — but the deck, the pizza, the wine shop and the head-on Grand Teton view earn it a coaster here.

Melvin Brewing ALPINE, WY (35 MIN S OF JACKSON) · WILDCARD · KIDS: YES — BREWPUB

GABF royalty (2x Brewpub of the Year). Worth it if anyone makes a beer run south.

Grand Teton Brewing VICTOR, ID (OVER TETON PASS) · WILDCARD · KIDS:

TAPROOM

Old-school mountain brewery — Bitch Creek ESB. Pair with a scenic Teton Pass drive.

Good to Know

- Late June up here: 70s by day, 30s-40s at night, afternoon thunderstorms that arrive like clockwork around 2pm and leave an hour later. Pack layers, rain shells, and sunscreen — the sun at 7,000 ft does not negotiate.
- Biscuit Basin (near Old Faithful) — CLOSED since the July 2024 hydrothermal explosion. The other basins are unaffected.
- Boiling River swim area (near Mammoth) — closed since the 2022 floods.
- Cell service is basically nonexistent outside the villages. Download offline maps before entering the park.